

Knowledge, skills and understanding

Knowledge and understanding

This Edexcel GCSE in Spanish requires students to develop their knowledge of vocabulary and structures in a range of settings which:

- are of relevance and interest to the student
- correspond to students' level of maturity
- reflect, and are appropriate to, the culture of countries and communities where the language is spoken
- relate, where appropriate, to other areas of the curriculum.

Skills

The Edexcel GCSE in Spanish qualification requires students to:

- listen and respond to different types of spoken language
- communicate in speech for a variety of purposes
- read and respond to different types of written language
- communicate in writing for a variety of purposes
- use and understand a range of vocabulary and structures
- understand and apply the grammar of the language, as detailed in the specification.

The Edexcel GCSE (Short Course) in Spanish: Spoken Language qualification requires students to:

- listen and respond to different types of spoken language
- communicate in speech for a variety of purposes
- use and understand a range of vocabulary and structures
- understand and apply the grammar of the language, as detailed in the specification.

The Edexcel GCSE (Short Course) in Spanish: Written Language qualification requires students to:

- read and respond to different types of written language
- communicate in writing for a variety of purposes
- use and understand a range of vocabulary and structures
- understand and apply the grammar of the language, as detailed in the specification.

Following on from the Key Stage 3 curriculum in Modern Languages, the Edexcel GCSE in Spanish provides **flexibility, choice** and **scope for personalised learning**. Teachers and students have considerable **control of content in the speaking and writing units** and are free to **focus** on **one** or more of the following broad themes.

Theme	Possible related content
	The following content is indicative only. Students may undertake work on other topics that relate to the chosen theme.
1. Media and culture	Music/film/reading Fashion/celebrities/religion Blogs/internet
2. Sport and leisure	Hobbies/interests Sporting events Lifestyle choices
3. Travel and tourism	Holidays Accommodation Eating, food, drink
4. Business, work and employment	Work experience/part-time jobs Product or service information
5. Centre-devised option	This option enables Spanish language learning to be linked to other areas of the curriculum not specified above. It may particularly appeal to centres offering content and language integrated learning (CLIL). NB: Centres should seek approval from Edexcel, using the <i>Ask the Expert Service</i> (see <i>Section C: Resources, support and training</i>).

Many students will appreciate the opportunity to focus on **one** broad theme relating to a specific interest or relevant curriculum area. However, it is acknowledged that some centres may wish to cover more than one theme, and this specification accommodates both approaches. Similarly, students can focus on one theme for the speaking unit and on a different one for the writing unit.

The qualification allows for **general, mixed** or **vocationally focused pathways** through the choice of themes. Although *travel and tourism* and *business, work and employment* offer more 'specialist' pathways, they provide **contexts** in which students can apply language skills and do not require any 'specialist' subject knowledge on the part of the student or teacher.

Alongside the themes, Edexcel has set the following four common topic areas and linked sub-topics. These, together with the minimum core generic vocabulary list (*Appendix 5*), have been produced to help teachers in planning and preparing students for the external examinations (*listening and understanding* and *reading and understanding*).

Common topic areas

The papers for listening and reading skills refer to the generic content areas specified below and feature scenarios set in a country where Spanish is spoken. All students, regardless of their chosen pathway and theme(s), will be expected to become familiar with them.

Out and about

- Visitor information
- Basic weather
- Local amenities
- Accommodation
- Public transport
- Directions

Customer service and transactions

- Cafés and restaurants
- Shops
- Dealing with problems

Personal information

- General interests
- Leisure activities
- Family and friends
- Lifestyle (healthy eating and exercise)

Future plans, education and work

- Basic language of the internet
- Simple job advertisements
- Simple job applications and CV
- School and college
- Work and work experience